PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
School District No. 1J, Multnomah County
Board of Education

May 5, 2026
School Board Retreat

In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Portland Public Schools Board of Education Retreat was held at the Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center at 501 N. Dixon Street, Portland, OR 97214, and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Board Members Present: Christy Splitt, Michelle DePass, Patte Sullivan,Rashelle Chase-Miller, Virginia La Forte, Stephanie Engelsman, and Eddie Wang.

Staff: Kimberlee Armstrong - Superintendent; Deborah Kafoury - Chief of Staff; Rosanne Powell - Senior Board Manager

Facilitators: Sandy Hayes - Bombastic Communications; Amy Cast - Bombastic Communications

Call to Order
The Board Retreat was called to order by Chair Wang at 5:35 p.m.

Governance Discussion
Sandy Hayes and Amy Cast asked Board Members and Superintendent Armstrong to reflect on how they were feeling and where they wanted to be as a governance team. They introduced the Governance Ecosystem concept and led a discussion about where policy design belongs within that framework. The Board reviewed the distinctions between policy, procedure, and guidelines and discussed how each contributes to effective board governance and organizational functionality. There was also discussion about guardrails, the School Board's purpose, roles and responsibilities, the difference between being a trustee versus an advocate, and the role of shared values.

Values Exploration
The Board participated in a values exploration exercise to identify the core values they share. The goal was to establish a common foundation that can guide future policy development and Board decision-making.

Policy Review
The Board reviewed Policy 1.10.010-P – Role of the Board of Education to determine whether it reflects the Board's identified values. During the discussion, members considered revisions to the Board's mission statement and identified several updates for the Policy Committee to consider, including adding language related to collaboration, teamwork, and accountability. There was also discussion about accountability and how it should be reflected within Board policy. There was also discussion on how operating protocols are considered. The Board emphasized the importance of grounding future work in its shared values, including updates to the Rightsizing Resolution and the Racial Educational Equity Policy.

Future Actions/Next Steps
The Board discussed next steps and how to apply its shared values to future Board goals, prioritization of work, and policy development. The Board Office will develop a menu of professional development opportunities for the board, including the possibility of attending a conference together.

Adjournment
Chair Wang adjourned the meeting at 8:50 p.m.

Submitted by:

Rosanne Powell
Senior Board Manager
Portland Public Schools